

Cataract Solutions

Prevention & Reversal Via Accelerated Self-Healing: Starter Excerpt

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What follows is drawn from the opening pages of *Cataract Solutions*, through the first natural therapy the book recommends. It is offered here exactly as he wrote it, lightly arranged, so you can hear directly from him before deciding whether to go further.

> "My cataracts have thinned since taking your Solution!"

> - Betty Gowler, Carlsborg, Washington

Foreword

Welcome to my world. It is a world of healing, where all things are possible, because it is a living, sentient world. I have worked in this wondrous world for four and a half decades, not counting working as a Vision Therapy Assistant in my father's office in high school and interning at the largest outpatient vision clinic in the world during my doctoral training. In that time, I have seen many things that are not explainable in the models of science I studied at Dartmouth and the State University of New York. I have witnessed a number of healings that defy textbook proclamations of irreversibility, including restoration of sight to the blind.

I find myself no longer relying on the limiting views of science as currently taught, though I prize the knowledge base of observation they draw upon. I look at these same observations now, and begin to see what might be. My mind seeks to know the mind of our creator, who manifests such an intricate and individualized world, and yet such a coherent and synergistic world when we can step aside from the ego and reason long enough to actually pay attention to what is with us here and now.

When I think about delving into the investigation of each unique individual seeking healing, I imagine looking at a snapshot in time of this wondrous machinery of life, a living machine, the bio-body suit through which our soul is gifted this opportunity to develop, learn, grow, to err and to heal. I think of Mother Theresa, who described her prayer life of conversing with the divine as "mostly listening." And when asked about God's communication with her, she said "mostly He listens." Healing for me is a deeply contemplative practice. A life in itself, a calling.

When I was 30, I learned that I was on a course that would surely end my life before age 40. Everything I needed to make the needed course correction was available in God's grand design. Healing is free, freely given and freely received. If you know someone who is in need of the information in this book, or of greater guidance, please let me know. My prayers go with you on your journey as well.

Preface

This book began to form when I was asked to speak at a conference of the International College of Applied Nutrition in Tokyo, Japan. I had become a Fellow of the College out of interest in the clinical application of nutrition in preventing and healing eye diseases, and I was just beginning my practice as a Doctor of Optometry, having founded the Optometric Center of Tokyo as my first office, with Japan's number two optical company, Sanki Gankyo, supporting my research in vision improvement.

The book took its next step as the research behind a one page handout designed to support patient education in my practice in New York, which became part of a clinical study reprinted as an appendix to this book. I continued my clinical explorations of accelerated self-healing based on biocommunication, and literature research was later added in preparation as co-author of *Natural Eyecare: An Encyclopedia: Complementary Treatments for Improving and Saving Your Eyes*, written with Marc Grossman, O.D., L.Ac. Information that didn't make

it into that book is gathered here, since a more comprehensive reference guide to natural remedies is often clinically useful.

Introduction

Cataracts form in a myriad of different patterns, and are caused in at least as many ways. Cataracts can be found at birth due to toxic conditions in the prenatal environment. Cataracts can be caused by trauma. Posterior subcapsular cataracts can advance rapidly in middle age, and are usually related to digestion and immune function. Poor regulation of sugar metabolism causes many cataracts, as does impaired liver function. Most cataracts change slowly over time, eventually disturbing vision so much that surgery is needed to remove the entire lens from inside the eye.

Prevention is especially effective in the early stages, where most people can begin to attain improved lens health in the first four weeks.

Why this book?

The purpose of this book is to help you, and maybe even your doctor, realize that there is much more that can be done for a person developing cataracts than the conventional "watch it until it is ripe for surgery." Surgery has its place. It is one half of the toolkit, the half that removes a lens that has already clouded past the point of return. In my decades of clinical experience, when we begin to take different actions in the other half, the half aimed at prevention and reversal, outcomes change remarkably.

I have spent four and a half decades helping thousands of people improve their visual health and fitness. Most of us would be expected to require cataract surgery about five years before we die. By preventing and reversing the beginnings of cataract, we can add to both quality and quantity of life, since those who live the longest also suffer the least from years of degenerative diseases.

The crystalline lens is simply the visible tip of the body's health, or degeneration, iceberg. It can save our lives like a canary in a coal mine.

Because the crystalline lens is the densest protein in the body, it is sequestered the farthest from its circulatory source of nutrition and detoxification. Because of the organic sulfur content that gives the lens this dense structure, it also stores any toxic load of mercury, such as from dental amalgams, longer than any other body tissue. Because it must be clear to allow light into the body for vision, the eye is the only interior tissue not protected from environmental ionizing radiation such as the sun's UV rays, and other high-energy photons that can trigger free radical pathology associated with aging processes.

I have counseled many hundreds of patients with the early stages of cataract, guiding them in the selection of appropriate dietary and nutritional supplement support as well as lifestyle changes, and have invariably seen at least some improvement where declining health is the expected norm.

For me, the real question is not just about avoiding the most common surgery covered by Medicare, but the fact that surgery does nothing to remove the causes of cataract, which are primarily states of toxicity and nutritional deficiency that continue to affect the rest of the body after a cataract is removed. So welcome to a very different world, where we can envision getting healthier and more functional as we age, like a fine wine.

This is why we have inherited the ancestral wisdom to enjoy "all good things in moderation." Everything we do can benefit from a fine tuned balance of dosage, frequency and intent, and only the body's innate wisdom can ultimately guide us there with perfect accuracy. We are being called, by our symptoms, to listen to this wisdom.

When I work with people individually, whether in person, measuring changes in the electrical conductivity at the acupuncture points, or tuning in spiritually through contemplation of a remote patron's energy field, the functional response patterns of the body's biocommunication system are the linguistics I am listening for, and they only know how to speak the truth. We must merely practice seeking, trusting, listening.

This is why, in my experience, your own body is your best doctor. Only the body can heal a wound, and when we listen to and begin to interpret the body's cries for help rather than suppressing them, we allow the body to elevate beyond healer to true doctor status. After all, *doctor* comes from *docere*, which means to teach. The body is always healing, and always ready to teach. We just need to be ready to listen and learn.

If you are looking to see what we know about the effects of God's natural pharmacy, the healing power of nature, in relation to cataracts, you will find that in the pages ahead. If you are seeking further guidance for accelerated self-healing, a book will not be the final answer, but when you find a healer or healing-oriented doctor you feel called to, comfortable with and trusting of, I pray that this book will help serve as a virtual member of your healing team, pointing toward valuable avenues and solutions to explore among the hundreds of specific healing items within these pages.

> This book is dedicated to my maternal grandmother, Frieda Porter, who radiated the luminosity of her Royal heritage from Alsace-Lorraine, and passed peacefully into the next life at age 98 with zero trace of cataracts.

Where to Begin: Antioxidants

The clarity of the crystalline lens in the eye is one of the most important predictors of longevity.

What do we know about nutrition in the prevention and reversal of cataractogenesis?

Free radical pathology is a major theme of cataract formation, as with most age-related and degenerative processes. Oxidation of cell membrane lipids may play an important role in cataractogenesis. Most of the nutritional components of cataract prevention and reversal are related to boosting antioxidant defenses. Taking a good, optimum potency multivitamin is an important foundation for a cataract prevention program, since the use of multi-vitamin and mineral

supplements has been identified as a preventive factor in the medical and epidemiological literature. A recent study using 26 vitamins and minerals reduced the risk of nuclear cataract by 36 to 44 percent. While a control group taking placebo tablets had their cataracts worsen over a 6 month study, others taking beta carotene and vitamin E experienced an initial improvement in vision, and did not decline further. Animal cataracts have also been reversed with nutritional supplements.

As we get older, there is typically a decrease in our ability to absorb and utilize nutrients. Correcting these factors with such remedies as microwater, friendly bacterial flora, digestive enzymes and homeopathics to stimulate nutrient utilization can also help us get the most out of our diet and our supplements.

There is much more waiting for you. This starter excerpt is only the foreword, preface, introduction and dedication of *Cataract Solutions*, plus its opening page on antioxidants, the first and most foundational of the natural therapies Dr. Glen recommends. The full book goes on, chapter by chapter, through light and radiation, botanicals, homeopathy, and the laboratory tests he uses to individualize a program, walking through the specific vitamins, minerals and forms of each, and the reasoning behind them, that four and a half decades of clinical practice and research have shown to matter most for the health of the lens.

If what you've just read resonates with where you are right now, whether you are newly noticing changes in your vision, managing a diagnosis, or supporting someone who is, the full book is the next step. And whenever you are ready to go further, Dr. Glen's Accelerated Self Healing work opens up through his free membership at illtowell.com. It costs nothing to begin.